

before all said it was the oldest [*sic*, presumably he meant ‘latest’], but now you say it represents the autograph perfectly? Are there K^r MSS which pre-date the 10-11th century?” (Both the men quoted above hold a PhD in New Testament textual criticism, and one would like to think that they had checked the evidence.)

Consider the following statement by Kirsopp Lake:

Writers on the text of the New Testament usually copy from one another the statement that Chrysostom used the Byzantine, or Antiochian, text. But directly any investigation is made it appears evident, even from the printed text of his works, that there are many important variations in the text he quotes, which was evidently not identical with that found in the MSS of the Byzantine text.¹

Having myself spent an occasional year in the arcane halls of academia, I have observed that the uncritical repetition of things that ‘everyone knows’ is really rather common, in almost any discipline. New Testament textual criticism is no exception, as Lake observed above.

I take it that Hermann von Soden was the first to formally identify his K^r as a distinct text-type, the ‘r’ standing for ‘revision’, since he considered it to be a revision based on his K^x. Well now, by definition a ‘revision’ is perpetrated by a specific someone, at a specific time and in a specific place. Within our discipline I gather that ‘revision’ and ‘recension’ are synonyms. Consider: “The Syrian text must in fact be the result of a ‘recension’ in the proper sense of the word, a work of attempted criticism, performed deliberately by editors and not merely by scribes.”² It is not my wont to appeal to Fenton John Anthony Hort, but his understanding of ‘recension’ is presumably correct. A recension is produced by a certain somebody (or group) at a certain time in a certain place. If someone wishes to posit or allege a recension/revision, and do so responsibly, he needs to indicate the source and supply some evidence.³

So, upon what basis did von Soden claim that his K^r (that I call Family 35) was a revision of his K^x, and created in the 12th century? Had he really paid attention to the evidence available in his own *magnum opus*,

¹ Kirsopp Lake, *The Text of the New Testament*, sixth edition revised by Silva New (London: Rivingtons, 1959), p. 53.

² B.F. Westcott and F.J.A. Hort, *The New Testament in the Original Greek* (2 vols.; London: Macmillan and Co., 1881), *Introduction*, p. 133.

³ Hort did suggest Lucian of Antioch as the prime mover—a suggestion both gratuitous and frivolous, since he had not really looked at the evidence available at that time. (Were he to repeat the suggestion today, it would be patently ridiculous.)